

SellKit User Onboarding and Guide

A short operating guide for Mariah Rubino to sign in, complete setup, review signal-backed targets, approve manual outreach drafts, and export rows without automatic sending.

Audience: Mariah Rubino

Mode: manual-first

Generated: Jun 9, 2026, 9:26 PM

What SellKit Does

SellKit helps Mariah review account and buyer recommendations before outreach. It combines account discovery, buyer discovery, signal evidence, buying committee research, scoring, and draft copy into one review queue.

No automatic send. SellKit prepares drafts and exports. Mariah reviews and approves before anything is copied, downloaded, or imported elsewhere.

Before First Use

- Use the approved work account to sign in.
- Confirm that external sourcing and enrichment tools are allowed under company policy.
- Keep provider keys server-side. Do not paste API keys into the browser or guide.
- Use manual email, manual CRM import, and manual LinkedIn steps until Microsoft, Salesforce, or LinkedIn access is approved.

First-Time Onboarding

Click **Edit Onboarding** and answer the five setup questions. The goal is not a perfect spec. The goal is enough context for SellKit to recognize the right big-tech account, the right executive buyer, the right trigger, and the right expert-services angle.

01
Account fit

02
Buyer fit

03
Offer

04
Signals

05
Voice

1

Ideal target company



Describe the account where outside experts would be credible and timely.

WHAT TO SAY

Use size, maturity, function, geography, and transformation context. For expert services, fit is usually about urgency plus complexity, not just industry.

Big tech

Enterprise SaaS

AI platform rollout

Cloud migration

Post-reorg execution

EXAMPLE ANSWER

Enterprise software or big-tech teams with 2,000+ employees, US first, active platform, AI, data, cloud, or product operating model initiatives. Avoid small startups unless they just hired a senior transformation leader.

Good SellKit input:

"Large engineering/product orgs dealing with AI adoption, platform modernization, cloud cost pressure, or post-reorg change. Prioritize teams that would value former Google, HP, MongoDB, or enterprise SaaS operators."

2

Buyer titles



Name who can feel the pain, sponsor the work, or bring in expert help.

STRONG YES TITLES

CTO, CIO, VP Engineering, VP Product, Head of Platform, Head of Data/AI, Chief Transformation Officer, GM, Product Ops, Engineering Enablement, or Strategy/Ops

CLOSE BUT NO

Recruiting-only titles, junior program managers, vendor management without business ownership, or people too far from the change initiative.

leaders attached to product and engineering.

Good SellKit input:

"Prioritize VP+ Product, Engineering, Data/AI, Platform, CIO/CTO, Transformation, and Product Ops. Avoid recruiters and junior PMO unless they report directly into a named transformation program."

3

One-line offer

Make the service concrete: who the experts are and what business problem they help with.



OFFER PATTERNS

Change management consultants, former product/engineering executives, domain experts, or fractional operators who help teams make a difficult initiative real.

AI adoption

Dev productivity

Product operating model

Platform scale

Cloud cost

EXAMPLE ANSWER

We connect enterprise product and engineering teams with proven operators and domain experts for urgent transformation work, from AI rollout and platform modernization to change management and executive advisory.

Avoid vague offers:

"Expert network access" is too generic. Better: "former product, engineering, AI, and change leaders who can help your team de-risk a specific initiative."

4

Buying signals

Rank the events that make expert help timely, not merely interesting.



HIGH-INTENT TRIGGERS

New CTO/CIO/VP Eng, major reorg, AI platform launch, hiring spike for platform/data/product ops, cloud cost initiative, acquisition integration, enterprise

WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE

A visible initiative plus an owner.
Example: "new VP Engineering hired in the last 90 days and the company is hiring platform productivity leaders."

transformation program, or public roadmap shift.

Good SellKit input:

"Strongest signals: new product/engineering leadership, AI/data platform rollout, change management after reorg, cloud or infra cost pressure, and senior hiring for platform/product ops."

5

Email voice



Give SellKit a real tone to imitate: direct, credible, and tied to the signal.

WHAT TO PROVIDE

One or two real emails, preferred subject length, whether to mention the signal, and how direct the ask should be.

EXAMPLE OPENER

"Saw your platform org is hiring around developer productivity after the AI infra rollout. We help teams bring in former product and engineering operators who have led similar transitions."

Good SellKit input:

"Short, plain, low-hype. Mention the specific signal in sentence one. Offer a useful expert angle, not a broad pitch. Ask for a quick compare-notes conversation."

Workstream
Enterprise Software

MR
Mariah Rubino

Mariah onboarding
5/5 answered
Human approval before send
Saved to account
Hide

Captures target profile, buyers, offer, signals, and email voice for the draft queue.

1. Ideal target company

Size, funding stage, industries in or out, and US-only or global.

Enterprise software companies with 1,000+ employees, US first, strong platform or data initiatives.

2. Buyer titles

Strong yes titles and close-but-no titles.

CTO, VP Engineering, VP IT, Head of Platform, Head of Data. Avoid junior ops and recruiters.

3. One-line offer

What SellKit should say she is selling.

Expert operators and fractional consultants for urgent technical initiatives.

4. Buying signals

Rank the strongest triggers and define what a good signal looks like.

New leadership, senior hiring spike, expansion funding, product launch, platform initiative.

5. Email voice

Paste one or two real emails, subject style, length, and whether to mention the signal.

Short, plain, direct. Mention the specific signal in the first sentence.

V1 operating mode

- ☒ Provider keys stay server-side in Supabase.
- ☒ Onboarding saves to this signed-in account.
- ☒ No Microsoft, Salesforce, or LinkedIn write access is required for V1.

Save Progress

PROVIDER ARCHITECTURE
Manual-first workflow

Use providers as stages, not substitutes

BD_COMPANIES

ACCOUNT DISCOVERY
Exa Company Search
Build ICP-matched company lists with safe query variations across industry, headcount, stage, and stack.

BD_CONTACTS

BUYER DISCOVERY
Exa People Search
Find buyer titles and likely decision makers using deduped people-category profile searches.

RANKED MATCHES

FAST LOOKUP
Parallel Entity Search
Use for interactive people or company searches when Mariah needs a quick candidate set.

Complete Mariah onboarding. Answer the five setup questions that shape account fit, buyer titles, signals, and email voice.

Daily Workflow

- Sign in:** open SellKit and authenticate with the approved account.
- Check provider stages:** confirm the provider architecture matches the workflow: Exa for discovery, Parallel for fast lookup and preview, Exa Agent for dossiers, Apollo and Clay for selective enrichment.
- Review the queue:** pick the highest-scored target and inspect the company, title, signal, and email confidence.
- Read evidence:** open source links where needed. The score should be explainable from visible evidence.

- Workstream

Enterprise Software

K

MR

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VERIFIED LISTS

SERIOUS LIST-BUILDING

Parallel FindAll / Exa Websets

Verify ICP criteria, collect cited matches, and enrich only the records that pass.

DOSSIERS

ACCOUNT DOSSIER

Exa Agent

Research committee, why-now, recent initiatives, and source-backed talking points.

REVIEW-READY ROWS

SELECTIVE ENRICHMENT

Apollo + Clay

Apollo verifies emails after scoring; Clay handles ambiguous rows and manual review fallbacks.

✓

1. Discovery

1,842

✓

2. Enrichment

1,103

✓

3. Scoring

542

○

4. Review

68

✕

5. Approved

23

Filters

Review Queue 68

⋮

All Scores

All Status

Newest First

	Target	Company	Score	Status	Added
✓	Sarah Chen VP, IT	D Datadog	92	New	28m ago
✕	Michael Torres	A Atlassian	88	New	1h ago

Review provider stages and queue. SellKit shows how Exa, Parallel, Apollo, and Clay contribute before Mariah reviews targets.

Buying Committee Map

Exa Agent + Parallel Task

Top likely buyers, current initiatives, and why Mariah should care.

PRIMARY BUYER

High

Sarah Chen, VP, IT

Recent initiative

Datadog expands AI observability investment

Why it matters

Closest owner for the active Datadog initiative and the best first approval path.

[Exa Agent evidence](#)

TECHNICAL CO-SPONSOR

Medium

VP, Platform Engineering

Recent initiative

Platform scale and reliability work surfaced in recent hiring and technical updates.

Why it matters

Likely feels the delivery pressure and can validate whether outside experts are useful.

[Parallel Task evidence](#)

BUDGET OR OPS SPONSOR

Medium

Head of Transformation / IT Operations

Recent initiative

Datadog is scaling Kubernetes and expanding AI observability.

Why it matters

Can connect the project to business impact, vendor approval, and operational urgency.

[Exa Agent evidence](#)

Evidence-First Scoring

Signal Strength

Datadog expands AI observability investment

25 / 30

[Signal source - 2026-06-01](#)

Title Fit

VP, IT matches Mariah's senior buyer filter.

24 / 25

[Profile evidence - Current](#)

Company Fit

1,001-5,000 Software account with AWS, Kubernetes, GCP.

22 / 25

[Company evidence - Current](#)

Signal Freshness

Detected from exa on 2026-06-01.

17 / 20

[Freshness evidence - 2026-06-01](#)

Email Confidence

sarah.chen@datadoghq.com is marked verified.

18 / 20

[Enrichment evidence - Today](#)

Score Factors

✓ Seniority: VP+

Strong

✓ Data / Product function

Strong

✓ Company size fit

Strong

✓ Recent buying signals

Strong

✓ Technographic fit

Good

[Approve Draft](#)

[Reject](#)

Manual Email Draft

[Copy](#)

To sarah.chen@datadoghq.com

Subject Quick thought for Datadog

Hi Sarah,

Inspect committee and evidence. Each target includes signal evidence, a buying committee map, and score factors with source links.

Approve the draft for manual handoff. Approve only after reviewing the draft. SellKit prepares copy, .eml, and CSV export, but does not send.

If SellKit sends you to the sign-in page, use the approved account and return to `/sellkit`.

<:>

SellKit

Sign in to review and approve sourcing drafts

Sign in

Create account

Email

you@company.com

Password

Enter your password

Sign in with email

OR

Continue with Google

Sign in to SellKit. Use the approved account and land back on /sellkit after authentication.

Provider Roles and API Appendix

Use the providers as stages in one workflow, not as substitutes for each other. This table is for operating SellKit after Mariah understands the basic review flow.

STAGE	BEST PROVIDER	USE IT FOR	GUARDRAIL
Account discovery	Exa Company Search	ICP-matched company lists by industry, headcount, geography, funding stage, and technology.	Use the company category, request highlights, and store structured company metadata separately from evidence snippets.

STAGE	BEST PROVIDER	USE IT FOR	GUARDRAIL
Buyer discovery	Exa People Search	Likely buyers, senior leaders, profile URLs, current role, location, and career context.	Run 2-3 query variations, dedupe by profile URL/name/company, and do not treat Exa as verified email.
Interactive lookup	Parallel Entity Search	Fast people/company results when Mariah types a natural-language search.	Use for candidate sets only. It is fast and cheap, but not a cited enrichment run.
ICP test	Parallel FindAll Preview	Cheaply evaluate about 10 candidates before paying for a full run.	Always preview first, read matched and unmatched candidates, then adjust match conditions.
Deep list-building	Parallel FindAll or Exa Websets	Verified account/person lists with reasoning, citations, enrichments, webhooks, and async completion.	Cap match limits, use webhooks for longer jobs, and only enrich matched candidates.
Account dossier	Exa Agent or Parallel Task	Buying committee maps, why-now research, recent initiatives, objections, and structured talking points.	Use bounded JSON schemas and require source URLs for every important claim.
Contact enrichment	Apollo	Verified work email, firmographic validation, and selective people/company enrichment after scoring.	Use after fit and signal scoring. Batch in groups of 10. Avoid phone and personal email by default.
Fallback review	Clay	Spreadsheet-style human enrichment queues and ambiguous rows that need manual review.	Test one row first, store credentials in Clay connections, set rate limits, and return only needed fields.

API Best Practices

Evidence-First Scoring

Every score component should be traceable. Store the provider, source URL, source title, source date, retrieval time, excerpt, confidence, and why the evidence matters.

- **Signal strength:** link to a press release, hiring page, earnings note, product post, or funding source.
- **Title fit:** link to the profile or public bio used to identify the buyer.
- **Company fit:** link to Exa company metadata or the source supporting headcount, industry, funding, or tech stack.
- **Email confidence:** show Apollo status separately from the score and keep raw enrichment output server-side.

Cost Controls

- Debounce interactive searches and cache provider responses by normalized query.
- Use Parallel Entity Search for quick lookups and FindAll Preview before full FindAll runs.
- Cap Exa Agent, Exa Websets, and Parallel FindAll list sizes before running.
- Use Apollo only after a target passes score thresholds. Bulk enrich in batches of 10.
- Do not enrich phone numbers or personal emails unless explicitly approved.

Compliance Defaults

- No automatic send. SellKit prepares copy, `.eml` files, and exports only after approval.
- No automatic LinkedIn action. SellKit can prepare a note and profile link for manual use.
- Keep all API keys server-side and never expose them in browser requests, screenshots, or exports.
- Keep raw provider payloads separate from normalized app rows so data can be audited or deleted.
- Use work email before personal email. Treat phone enrichment as disabled unless Mariah explicitly opts in.

Provider References

- [Exa Company Search](#) - company discovery and structured company metadata.
- [Exa People Search](#) - professional profiles and buyer discovery.
- [Exa Agent](#) - deep research, grounded structured JSON, and account dossiers.
- [Exa Websets](#) - verified async list-building and enrichment.
- [Parallel Entity Search](#) - fast synchronous people and company lookup.

- **Parallel FindAll Preview** - cheap validation before full FindAll runs.
- **Parallel FindAll** - cited, verified, enriched list-building.
- **Apollo People Enrichment** - verified contact enrichment after scoring.
- **Clay HTTP API** and **Clay Webhooks** - manual enrichment workspace and row handoff.

Troubleshooting

- **Login loop:** sign out, reopen the SellKit URL, and use the approved account.
- **Copy is disabled:** approve the draft first. Copy/download stays disabled before approval.
- **CRM export is not ready:** approve at least one target.
- **Draft sounds wrong:** update the onboarding email voice field with a real example.
- **Score seems unclear:** inspect Evidence-First Scoring and source links before approving.

Policy reminder. Keep the app manual-first until company policy approves direct Microsoft, Salesforce, or LinkedIn integrations.

Generated from the local SellKit app at <http://127.0.0.1:5173>. Screenshots are stored in [output/guide-screenshots/sellkit](#).